

CAYO DE AGUA

Complete Tour & Travel Guide — Los Roques, Venezuela

1. Destination Overview

Cayo de Agua is one of the most famous and photogenic cays in the Los Roques Archipelago, a protected Caribbean national-park destination off Venezuela. It is especially known for brilliant turquoise water, white coral sand and the narrow sandbar/land bridge connecting sections of the cay. The cay is remote and has very limited or no visitor services, so a day trip normally requires carrying everything you need.

2. How to Reach Los Roques

Travelers normally reach the Los Roques Archipelago by small aircraft to Gran Roque, the inhabited island and operational hub. Published travel information describes the flight from the Caracas/La Guaira area as roughly 30–40 minutes. Private yachts are another possible route, but there is no regular commercial ferry from mainland Venezuela. Current departure airports and flight schedules should be confirmed immediately before booking because aviation arrangements can change.

3. How to Reach Cayo de Agua

Cayo de Agua is reached by boat from Gran Roque. Because it is a distant cay, the crossing is substantially longer than trips to nearby cays such as Madrisquí or Francisquí. A typical organized excursion is a full-day outing, with an early departure and an afternoon return. Exact sailing time depends on the boat, route and sea conditions; current local sources commonly describe roughly 45–60 minutes each way.

4. Why Visit Cayo de Agua?

- Walk the iconic white-sand connection between the cay sections when conditions and tide permit.
- Swim in clear, shallow Caribbean water in suitable sheltered areas.
- Snorkel around reefs and rocky edges where conditions are safe.
- Photograph the sandbar, turquoise lagoons and surrounding cays.
- Enjoy a quiet, undeveloped beach experience far from urban tourism.

5. Suggested Day-Trip Itinerary

Time	Suggested plan
07:30–08:30	Breakfast in Gran Roque and confirm boat, weather and pickup arrangements.
08:30–09:00	Walk to the pier and board the lancha/peñero.
09:00–10:00	Boat transfer toward Cayo de Agua, depending on conditions.
10:00–13:00	Beach time, swimming, photography and snorkeling at safe locations.
13:00–14:00	Packed lunch / beach lunch. Keep all rubbish with you.
14:00–15:30	More beach time and exploration; follow the boatman's safety instructions.
15:30–17:00	Return boat to Gran Roque; timing varies with operator and sea conditions.

6. Best Time to Visit

Los Roques is generally most popular during the drier period from about December to May, when weather is often more stable. Conditions can still vary, and wind can affect boat crossings and swimming. Cayo de

Agua is particularly dependent on sea conditions because it is a distant cay. Always confirm the forecast and the boatman's recommendation on the day of travel.

7. Tide & Sandbar Safety

The famous sand connection is shaped by tides, currents and changing sea conditions; its appearance and walkability are not guaranteed. Never assume the sandbar is safe to cross simply because it is visible. Ask your local boat crew about current conditions, avoid strong currents and do not swim across exposed channels.

8. What to Bring

Plenty of drinking water • packed lunch/snacks • reef-safe sunscreen • hat • sunglasses • swimsuit • towel • dry bag • waterproof phone case • snorkeling equipment if not supplied • basic medicines • cash for local expenses. There may be no reliable shade, food shop, freshwater supply or toilet service at the cay.

9. Tour Costs & Park Fees

Prices vary significantly by season, operator, group size and whether the boat is private or shared. Distant-cay trips such as Cayo de Agua generally cost more than nearby-island transfers. Los Roques also has a national-park entrance fee, with amounts varying by nationality and age. Confirm the current fee and whether it is included in your package before departure.

10. Accommodation

Most visitors stay in a posada on Gran Roque rather than on Cayo de Agua. Posadas often help arrange daily boat excursions and may bundle meals and transfers. Staying on Gran Roque makes it easier to organize Cayo de Agua and other cays during a multi-day visit.

11. Recommended 3-Day Los Roques Plan

Day 1 — Arrive at Gran Roque, settle into your posada, explore the village and enjoy a nearby beach.

Day 2 — Full-day Cayo de Agua excursion with beach time and snorkeling.

Day 3 — Visit a nearer cay such as Francisquí or Madrisquí, then return to Gran Roque for departure.

12. Responsible Travel

Los Roques is a protected marine environment. Do not touch coral, collect shells or wildlife, feed animals, or leave plastic and other rubbish behind. Use reef-conscious sunscreen and keep boat and snorkeling activities within local rules. Follow instructions from park authorities and local boat operators.

13. Important 2026 Travel Note

Flight and airport arrangements for Los Roques can change, so verify your exact departure airport, airline, baggage allowance and flight schedule before purchasing a connecting ticket. Current destination information also recommends confirming park fees and local transport arrangements in advance.

Quick Checklist

✓ Flight to Gran Roque confirmed ✓ Posada booked ✓ Cayo de Agua boat reserved ✓ Weather/sea conditions checked ✓ Park fee confirmed ✓ Water and food packed ✓ Sun protection ✓ Dry bag ✓ Cash ✓ Travel insurance ✓ Return-flight plan